

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 4

New Case: Rohan (26 y/o) – Contamination OCD + Checking

Highly Detailed – Realistic Style

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	Rohan (26 years, Male, Software Engineer, Bangalore)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	4 of 18–20	Focus:	Building Motivation + Preparing for ERP

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client arrived looking tired but more engaged than previous sessions. He completed monitoring on all 7 days and practiced labeling + delaying on several occasions. He reported that labeling helped him create some distance from the thoughts, and he was able to delay compulsions for 1–3 minutes on moderate-anxiety days. On high-anxiety days, he still struggled significantly. Today's plan: Review homework, continue building motivation by exploring values and long-term goals, introduce one more defusion technique if helpful, begin gentle discussion of ERP hierarchy, and assign new homework. Maintain gentle, non-pressuring pace.

SESSION START – HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, Rohan. How has your week been? I see you brought the full monitoring notes this time. How did the labeling and delaying practice go?

Client: (speaking in a low but slightly more open voice) I did the monitoring every day. Labeling helped a bit — when I said “This is an OCD thought” in my mind, it felt like the thought lost a little bit of its power. I was able to delay washing for 1–3 minutes on some days when the anxiety wasn't too high. On bad days, I still couldn't stop myself. I checked the switches at night almost every day. Overall, I feel like I'm trying, but progress is very slow.

Therapist: Thank you for being so consistent with the monitoring and for practicing the new skills. Even small delays and moments of distance from the thoughts are meaningful steps. Progress in OCD treatment is often slow and gradual — that's completely normal. You mentioned that on “bad days” it was much harder. What made those days different?

Client: On bad days I had to go outside more or touch things at work. The thoughts felt much stronger and scarier. I felt like if I didn't wash immediately, something bad would definitely happen. On those days I couldn't even try delaying.

BUILDING MOTIVATION – VALUES AND LONG-TERM GOALS

Therapist: Last session we looked at the current cost of OCD. Today, let's look at the other side — what kind of life you would like to have if OCD wasn't controlling so much of your time and energy. This can help strengthen your motivation for the harder parts of treatment, like ERP. What's important to you in life? What kind of person do you want to be, or what kind of experiences do you want to have?

Client: I want to be able to meet friends without worrying so much. I want to feel less tired all the time. I want to be able to focus better at work without my mind always going to contamination. I also want to feel like I'm not broken or weird. I miss feeling normal.

Therapist: Those are very human and meaningful goals — connection with friends, energy, focus at work, and feeling like yourself again. OCD is currently taking away from all of these. When you think about continuing to work on reducing the compulsions, even though it will be difficult at times, how important does it feel in light of these goals?

Client: It feels important. I don't want to keep living like this for the next 10–20 years. I want to have a normal life. But I'm still scared of what will happen if I stop the washing and checking.

Therapist: That fear is very real and understandable. We'll work with it carefully and gradually. The fact that you can clearly see both the cost of OCD and the life you want is a strong foundation for moving forward when you're ready.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue monitoring washing and checking
2. Continue practicing labeling (“This is an OCD thought”) when contamination thoughts arise
3. Continue trying to delay compulsions by 1–3 minutes when possible
4. Write down 2–3 things that are important to you in life (values or goals) that OCD is currently interfering with

Client: I'll try the values part. It might help me remember why I want to keep trying even when it's hard.

Therapist: That's a great way to think about it.

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your practice with labeling and delaying, and we looked at the life you want beyond OCD. How are you feeling about today's session?

Client: It was okay. Thinking about the life I want made me feel more motivated, but I'm still scared of ERP. The values exercise felt useful.

Therapist: That's completely fair. Any questions before we finish?

Client: Not really.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Client showed continued engagement with labeling and delaying techniques with partial success.
- Clear motivation emerging from connecting OCD costs with personal values and desired life.
- Client remains appropriately cautious about fully engaging in ERP.
- Next session: Review values homework, continue building motivation, begin collaborative development of ERP hierarchy if client shows readiness, introduce more advanced defusion or mindfulness techniques if helpful.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.